



Maulik Jasubhai Publisher

Publisher's Note

Waking Up To A Brand New Day

INNOVATION IS A peculiar challenger—it keeps staring at you all the time, but almost always waits for you to make the first move.

Grappling with this challenger has been a delightful and rewarding experience—both for us, and for our readers.

When Ernst and Young certified our print run of 1.2 lakh earlier this year, we were humbled more than proud. That *Digit* is India's undisputed leader in the tech media segment bears no repetition. Therefore, it would have surprised many when we decided it requires change—a complete makeover that would give it a new skin, a new personality.

Why, many asked? *Digit's* readership is by far the largest in the tech media segment, and despite new entrants in the market, has held on to its No 1 position with the possessiveness of an Australian cricket captain holding on to his World Cup.

But change and innovation have been deep, underlying philosophies at *Digit*. We were India's first magazine to give a free CD, and later, two. In December 2003, we became India's first publication to give a movie VCD free (*Ice Age*). In August 2003, we bundled a free Linux DVD.

Our competitors followed by giving DVDs once in a while, or copying our packaging all the while. Even their CD nomenclature was similar. We were humbled again.

Imitation, as the Mahatma said, is the most sincere form of flattery.

From August 2004, we decided to pleasantly surprise our readers once again. *Digit* is now India's first magazine to give a DVD free with every issue—4.3 GB of the best software, the best games, the best entertainment. And we won't be

surprised if this time too, competition follows our lead.

As a magazine, too, *Digit* has evolved. It underwent this makeover because our reader is now more technology-aware than ever before. Technology is no longer on an esoteric geek plane, but something he uses every day, in every imaginable (and perhaps, unimaginable) way. It is no longer just about inanimate hardware and mute software; it is now about people, and how they use it in real life situations. It is about what technology can do for us, in ways we sometimes did not even realise it could.

I hope you enjoy your favourite magazine's new avatar, and continue to be fellow travellers on this exciting journey.

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PS: I would like to introduce Sachin Kalbag, *Digit's* new Executive Editor. He has been with us for six months, and brings with him 10 years of media experience—print, radio and Web. In between qualifying for the final rounds of BBC Mastermind, reading up on world mythology, and listening to Django Reinhardt, he teaches journalism in Mumbai. Apart from that, he says, he pretty much does nothing.

Meanwhile, our dear Sumod shall continue to be the 'geek on board', guiding you through the labyrinth of core technologies.